

You feel like you're faking it every time you lead a meeting with more energy than you actually feel.

That is not inauthenticity.

Most introverted leaders have accepted a quiet story about themselves: "I am just not naturally charismatic. That is not who I am."

Here is what the story gets wrong.

Charisma is a behavior, not a trait. The colleague who seems effortlessly confident in every room has been practicing those behaviors, usually without thinking, since they were children. They have more reps. That is not a personality advantage. It is a head start.

You can close the gap. Not by pretending to be someone else. By identifying one specific behavior, finding someone who does it well, studying the mechanics, and practicing in low-stakes situations before high-stakes ones.

The feeling of "this is natural" comes after the practice. Not before.

You do not have to wait to feel ready. You have to decide what you are practicing.

What is one leadership behavior you have been treating as a personality trait when it might actually be a skill?

#leadership #techleadership #leadershipdevelopment